

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

\$8,000 on a Jeep for his son, who had wrecked it without insurance coverage; and the doctor had bought him another one. It went on and on. When I asked him about these expenditures, he said, "But that was an abnormal month. That couldn't happen every month."

But as we looked back over the previous five or six months, it seemed that something equivalent had happened every month. He had so much money in oil wells that he could have bought part of Texas.

He had almost convinced me that he could control his spending without drastic measures until we walked into his backyard and I saw an airplane without wings. I asked him, "Why in the world do you have an airplane in your backyard? Does anyone in your family fly?"

"No, nobody flies. I bought it as a tax shelter because it would be a good depreciating asset." I congratulated him on the selection of that investment because it had really depreciated in his backyard!

As we began developing a budget, I found that he could have lived on a fourth of what he made and maintained the same standard of living. Obviously, he could not have bought the new cars, Jeeps, greenhouses, or all the other indulgences he was involved with, including several "get-rich-quick" programs.

He and his wife settled on a budget of \$24,000 a year. Before I left I said to his receptionist, "If he wants to get any more money, call me first."

During the next months, they lived within their budget simply by adjusting spending to the necessary rather than the lavish. After eight or nine months, I received a call from the good doctor, and I could almost see him beaming through the phone. "I've found that we have our spending under control and three things have happened as a result. First, I'm able to reduce the fees in my practice. Second, we're able to have surplus money and use it for both our family and the Lord's work. Best of all though, we have peace in our lives for the first time ever."